> She travelled up and down the country like some knight-errant of old, rescuing distressed damsels, and . . . bringing justice and succour to lonely women who had no other reliable helper. She travelled [by] every kind of conveyance—boat, train, elephant and palanquin. She crossed flooded rivers or camped under the stars in sandy wastes. Always she must be on the move, even when fever or weariness demand rest.

Ignoring fever and weariness, millions of migrant women who work as domestic maids in contemporary India positively contribute to their own households.[42] Female migration from east India to garment factories in south India is now a feasible option to earn decent wages.[43] Many Muslim women in Delhi have migrated from small-town prejudices and the tight gaze of their families to lead more fulfilling lives.[44] Women from specific regions are also occupying niche sectors in Delhi: Rajasthani construction workers, tribal women from Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha and Chhattisgarh as live-in maids, educated English-speaking women from the Northeast in tourism, airlines and beauty and health parlours, and nurses from Kerala.[45] The phenomenon of nursing ambitions in particular is remarkable because it is dominated by Christian Malayalis, who work all over India and the world.[46] Christians were first movers in this field because of fewer taboos on working in this profession compared to other religions, though their success has now paved the way for others to join in. The nursing ambition is one of step-migration, first within Indian states, then to the Gulf and finally the rich countries of the West. All through, they send back considerable amounts of remittances to support their families. It is a rare case of all-women migration networks spanning the world. It has led to the mushrooming of private nursing schools in Kerala, mirroring the rise of private computer training centres in Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh for (mostly male) software engineers. And just as the America boys are valued in the marriage market, so are the Malayali nurses. So much so that matrimonial columns which used to first advertise for nurses working in the Gulf have now switched to simply seeking women who have cleared the examinations that test proficiency in English and nursing, knowing very well the value attached to the profession. From Marie Rozette in 18th century Mauritius to Anandibai Joshee and Cornelia Sorabji in the 19th